



The Shadow Court's tradition of Samhain revelry — and mockery — continued even past the Resurgence. Since the Evanescence, however, the Shadow Court has taken on a new purpose. As Glamour withdrew from the world and freeholds collapsed, the leadership of both courts did nothing. Changelings without the luxury of a freehold or access to reliable Dreamers couldn't scrape together enough Glamour to keep from being Undone, and still those with the most resources offered no relief. When changelings, facing the icy winds of Banality with no protection, demanded answers from their superiors, they were met with only silence.

Commoners and landless nobles banded together under the banner of the Shadow Court to make their voices heard. Rank and file members don't know if the inaction from the highest-ranking Kithain is due to malice or if — insulated in their freeholds with a limitless supply of Glamour — they're completely out of touch with the hardships faced by the average changeling. Frankly, those who count themselves among the Shadow Court don't care. Their only goal is to force a response from those capable of alleviating some of the suffering. They take inspiration for their tactics from, and inspire in turn, the protests of similar groups in human society — the Occupy movement, the Arab Spring, and Black Lives Matter to name a few. Whenever the Shadow Court discovers a high-ranking noble will make a public appearance, they gather in numbers impossible to ignore to disrupt the proceedings. The aim is to show the elites of Kithain society that they exist and that they will not submit to their circumstances quietly.

The Shadow Court's famous Samhain celebrations continue every year. They have taken on a Mardi-Gras-like quality. All who attend come costumed as someone of importance. This allows the assembled changelings one night of the year when they can indulge in their fantasies and forget their troubles, if only briefly. Shadow Court organizers use the night to plan their strategy for the coming year, and to check on everyone in their

community so they can make sure whatever little aid they receive gets to those who need it most. Rumors are whispered by some who refuse to join the Shadow Court that other, more sinister proceedings happen each Samhain. They say the true masters of darkness come out that night, shrouded by the safety of the mists, to direct the Shadow Court to its original purpose — the downfall of Kithain society. The leaders of the Shadow Court dismiss these allegations as obvious propaganda from the leaders of the Seelie and Unseelie Courts, who are terrified they might be forced to relinquish a small portion of their amassed Glamour.

Changeling Society

Changeling society worldwide has certain similarities, mostly having to do with commonalities of Kith and culture. What follows presents a picture of many changeling political groupings. Though not comprehensive, this summary should present material for players and Storytellers alike.

Newly-awakened changelings not only discover they have taken on new individual identities, but also that they belong to a society made up of several types of fae. Changeling society operates under its own structures, laws, and customs. Each new changeling must quickly incorporate and understand these aspects if she plans to coexist with her Kithain fellows. Left to themselves, new fae almost invariably fall to Banality. A loner just can't stand up to the constant barrage of denial that surrounds him in the mundane world.

Basic groups of the changeling world are the noble households (different from the noble houses) and commoner motleys. Households and motleys both seek out new changelings to incorporate into their group, as each represents a new part of the Dreaming. Members of both groups usually swear an oath (p. 264) to the household or motley, promising loyalty and assistance, if not outright friendship.

Usually centered around a freehold, both households and motleys obtain their powers and influence from these pockets of the Dreaming that shelter changelings from the Banality of the mundane world around them. Providing protection for a freehold is often the primary duty of each changeling group.

Households

A household encompasses a group of changelings who all live together in a freehold and serve the noble lord there as vassals or retainers. Households exist under the feudal system imposed by the Resurgent sidhe. They align themselves with the noble hierarchy and are the backbone of the Kingdom of Concordia and its subject kingdoms. Each household displays the coat of arms of its lord or lady, who must hold at least the rank of knight. Most such rulers are of baron or greater rank.

Those within a household take pride in their holding, finding opportunities to enhance their successes and elevate their reputations. These reflect well on each member of the household just as great deeds reflect glory on the house as a whole. Most households have rivals and try to outdo them at everything from reputation to confrontations on the battlefield, or at jousting tourneys, in courtly romance, or hosting fine parties.



The Black Court

The rumors about the Shadow Court are not far from the truth. While it wasn't founded by the Thallain, it was soon taken over by them. The Thallain were invited to join by the Shadow Court's Unseelie founders who thought the Thallain were so few and so mindless they would make useful, if crude, tools. The Thallain, while rare at the time, were not as stupid as the court's founders thought. They quickly recognized the Shadow Court's potential to destabilize the Kithain. They usurped the original founders but made sure to keep their existence hidden from the rest of the Shadow Court. They adopted the name of the Black Court in honor of their absent Fomorian masters. Today they direct Thallain activity across the world while fracturing Kithain society from their place atop the Shadow Court.